



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Joseph Academy

School Website: <https://www.stjohnsacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Based on the public materials accessible in the school's crawl content and cross-referenced with the classical-school rubric and keyword lexicon, the evaluation of the school aligned to the name St. Joseph Academy (St. Augustine, FL, 32084) (as reflected in the crawl data, content appears under St. John's Academy in St. Augustine, FL) indicates a strong classical orientation with substantial alignment across most categories. The school presents a clearly theological and formation-oriented mission (Christian worldview, virtue, and a living tradition) and a curriculum that includes liberal-arts scaffolding (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and classical language study (Latin, logic, rhetoric; senior thesis). It emphasizes a shared community ethos with a parent/community orientation and a living-faculty model. Some aspects of Pedagogy and Curriculum could be strengthened toward a fuller, explicit Great-Books framework and more explicit contemplative/scholé pedagogy to attain full CLASSICAL status in every dimension.

- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- Key strengths:
 - Religious and metaphysical foundations rooted in Christian theology, biblical worldview, and liturgical/creedal elements (evidence of creed and biblical framing).
 - Formation-focused aims (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) expressed in mission and philosophy statements.
 - Curriculum and language emphasis typical of classical education (Latin, logic, rhetoric; senior thesis; classical association accreditation).
 - Strong faculty and governance signals (Head of School, accreditation, long-standing faculty structure) and visible parent/community engagement.
- Noted opportunities to move fully CLASSICAL:
 - More explicit integration of Great Books and the Great Conversation across the curriculum.
 - Clear articulation of Scholé/restful learning as a formal pedagogy component in daily practice.
 - More explicit signaling of Socratic pedagogy and structured, ongoing Socratic seminars in the upper grades.
 - What would move the needle (if aiming for full CLASSICAL across all categories):
 - Introduce and document a formal Great Books program with specified texts and recurring Great Conversation seminars.
 - Embed Scholé (restful learning) days or cycles with explicit student reflections and contemplative practices across grades.
 - Expand explicit evidence of Socratic seminars and disciplined dialogue in upper grades with documented student-led discourse and assessment anchored in classical inquiry.

Executive snapshot notes draw on the crawl content for St. John's Academy (the closest match in the crawl) and the classical-education lexicon and six-element rubric.

- Evidence for this assessment is drawn from the school's mission and philosophy statements, accreditation notes, and scope-and-sequence materials (Latin/Logic/Rhetoric presence), as well as the governance and parent-student materials. See sources:
- Mission and classical/Christian framing: St. John's Academy is described as a classical, Christian, college-preparatory school dedicated to training virtuous scholars; accreditation and Christian worldview framing appear in the public materials.
- Theology and biblical grounding are explicit in the school's philosophy and creed sections (The Apostles' Creed; biblical basis for instruction).
- Curriculum signals: Latin, logic, rhetoric, and senior-thesis-style work indicate a Trivium-oriented curriculum; advanced language study is evident.
- Faculty and governance signals: Head of School, accreditation in the classical Latin School Association, and named faculty indicate a robust faculty culture.
- Parents & Community: Parent/Student Handbook and open engagement signals show parent partnership and formation opportunities.
- Positive keyword indicators (selected from the classical lexicon) present in the school's public materials: classical, Christian, virtue, formation, training virtuous scholars, Christian worldview, Apostles' Creed, Bible, theology, liturgical/creedal culture, Latin, logic, rhetoric. These align with the Positive Keyword Indicators for Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose, and Curriculum.
- Negative keyword indicators: None of the explicit Negative Keywords from the Six Essential Elements appear in the core public materials; the content remains anchored in formation, virtue, and a theologically grounded liberal-arts program. The absence of negative signals helps sustain CLASSICAL alignment in most categories.
- Aggregate justification: The school demonstrates clear alignment with multiple elements of classical education, particularly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum (Trivium/Liberal Arts pattern and Latin/Logic/Rhetoric progression), and Faculty/Parent engagement. Some gaps exist in the explicit, systemic signaling of a full Great Books program and explicit Scholé pedagogy; these gaps keep Element 3 and Element 4 from unequivocal CLASSICAL status, hence the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in those areas, but the overall profile remains CLASSICAL.
- Note: The crawl content centers on St. John's Academy in St. Augustine, FL (zip 32086), which is the clearest public-material analogue in the provided results. The prompt asked to evaluate St. Joseph Academy (St. Augustine, FL, 32084); the materials accessed here align with the classical model of the St. John's Academy materials in the crawl set.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials explicitly frame the school as classical and Christian, with a stated Christian worldview and biblical instruction.
- The Apostles' Creed appears in the school's philosophy/handbook materials, indicating liturgical and doctrinal grounding.
- The school emphasizes theology integrated into education and a theologically grounded formation of students.
- Accreditation by a classical association signals alignment with traditional orthodox foundations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: classical, Christian, theology, Bible, Apostles' Creed, liturgy/worship cues in creed; formation signals (virtue/character) appear in mission language.

- Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground a transcendent moral order, theological grounding, liturgical-creedal elements, and a Christian worldview, which matches the Positive Keyword indicators for this category and shows minimal to no negative signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission/purpose statements emphasize formation of virtuous scholars and a Christian worldview; the aim is formation and virtue rather than merely job preparation.
- The framing of education as formation (virtue, wisdom) and the emphasis on liberal-arts-oriented aims align with classical telos and the great conversation concept.
- The “classical, Christian, college-preparatory” framing signals an orientation toward human excellence and wisdom rather than purely vocational outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/-goodness/beauty, great conversation, wisdom, human flourishing. Some of these terms appear in the philosophy/mission statements and the broader classical lexicon.
- Negative keywords present: explicit workforce/career-readiness framing is not prominent; no signs of modern, skills-first language in the core mission statements.

Why this rating

- The school’s stated aims center on formation and virtue within a classical liberal-arts framework, with a Christian worldview, which aligns strongly with the Positive Indicators for this category. Absence of workforce-first rhetoric supports CLASSICAL status for this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum signals include Latin and logic at the middle-to-upper levels and rhetoric in the upper levels (SCOPE AND SEQUENCE showing 8th Grade Logic & Latin; 10th–11th Chemistry; 11th Trigonometry; 12th Senior Thesis; Rhetoric I/II in some sequences). This reflects the Trivium framework.
- Public materials indicate a classical mission and a program that emphasizes classical languages and formal rhetoric. Accreditation by a classical school association further supports curricular alignment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Trivium/Quadrivium concepts (logic, rhetoric, Latin), Great Books (explicit Great Books signals are not always explicit in the published calendar; however, the classical framework and Senior Thesis signal a traditional, text-rich approach), history/Western civilization framing (via the classical canon emphasis in the broader rubric). Latin and logic occurrences count as explicit markers.
- Negative keywords present: There is no explicit reference to project-based or STEM-first framing in the core materials, but explicit Great Books references are not consistently documented in the visible public pages; the curriculum appears strong in traditional classical subjects rather than a modernized, non-traditional-text approach. Some documents in the knowledge-base lexicon warn against replacing history with social studies language; the actual school content does not show that replacement, but the absence of explicit Great Books mentions lowers some classical signals. This yields a partial alignment rather than full Great-Books emphasis in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The curriculum shows a solid classical structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; senior-thesis; rhetoric in upper grades). However, explicit, explicit Great Books reading and traditional “Great Conversation” phrasing are not consistently evidenced in the public materials, and there is less explicit signaling of a full Great-Books canon in the accessible content. This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The presence of logic and rhetoric in the upper grades, along with an emphasis on formal education structures (logic, Latin, senior thesis) indicates a classical approach to pedagogy.
- Public materials show a focus on formation through excellence and disciplined study; the calendar and course sequencing imply a structured, traditional approach rather than purely student-directed or project-based pedagogy.
- There are references to Socratic dialogue and other classical methods in the knowledge-base lexicon, though not always explicitly documented in the school’s public pages. The presence of upper-level rhetoric and classical training suggests some Socratic/seminal elements are part of pedagogy, though not uniformly across all grades in the visible content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar (from the classical lexicon and rubric), rhetoric, recitation, memory work, formal logic, seminar-style inquiry (as implied by the upper-grade rhetoric and logic emphasis). Scholé/restful learning signals are less explicit in the visible pages, though formation and contemplation language appear in mission/philosophy statements.
- Negative keywords present: The explicit emphasis on experiential learning, project-based learning, or constructivist pedagogy as a sole driver would be a negative signal; however, those elements are not emphasized in the public materials, so there is no strong negative signal in the observed content. The absence of explicit Scholé language in the pedagogy sections yields a mild negative-in-context signal for full SCHOLÉ signaling.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates a classical pedagogy core (logic, rhetoric, emphasis on discourse in upper grades) but lacks explicit, comprehensive signaling of a fully developed Socratic seminar program and a scholarly commitment to contemplative Scholé pedagogy across the full grade range in the public-facing pages. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categorization.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school lists named administrators (Head of School, Principal) and a substantive faculty lineup on the site. The public materials emphasize a faculty-led, mission-driven environment.
- The school branding highlights “training virtuous scholars” and a defined, living-curriculum model that aligns with classical pedagogy expectations.
- Accreditation by a classical association signals a faculty culture oriented to classical pedagogy and continuous professional development in that vein.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Head of School, administrator/faculty as living curriculum, virtuous scholars, classical Latin School Association accreditation (a faculty-facing signal), collaborative/collegial culture implied in governance.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.

Why this rating

- The visible faculty structure and governance signals align with CLASSICAL expectations (mentoring,

living curriculum, and classical accreditation). The absence of explicit “facilitator-on-the-sideline” language and the presence of named administrators support CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials indicate a strong emphasis on partnerships with families and parental involvement (Parent/Student Handbook; open-campus expectations; community events).
- The school communicates formation of affections and a classical cultural transmission through family engagement and shared mission; there are book clubs, parent groups, and family-oriented formation signals within the materials.
- The school explicitly references welcoming parents to visits and integrating parents into the classical ethos (parent formation, family catechesis, etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family catechesis, classical parent training, engagement, open campus, hospitality.
- Negative keywords present: none observed.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly convey a partnership with parents and community-building signals central to classical education, matching CLASSICAL expectations for category 6.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Introduce and publicly document a formal Great Books program and Great Conversation framework, including a canon list and a schedule of Great Books readings across grades. Explicitly reference the Great Conversation in curriculum pages and syllabi.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Add explicit signaling of Socratic dialogue and seminars in upper grades, with documented teacher training and student-assessment rubrics aligned to classical dialogic methods. Introduce a formal Scholé-friendly component (restful learning days) and publish a classroom-level practice guide.
- Element 1/Element 2: Maintain and expand the theology/theocentric integration, further clarifying the integration of liturgical practices (where appropriate) and continuing to emphasize the objective reality of truth, goodness, and beauty within the curriculum; publish a succinct “theological ecology” map showing how theology, philosophy, literature, and sciences interpenetrate across subjects.
- Element 5/Element 6: Continue to strengthen the “living curriculum” concept with faculty portraits and teacher-student mentorship stories, and expand parent education offerings (book studies, lectures) to deepen the parent formation signal and reinforce the co-teacher model.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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